

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4-Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	K-Louisiana Combined Application Project (LaCAP)
	Section No./Name	K-500-LaCAP Changes
	Document No./Name	K-520-LaCAP Action on Changes
	Effective Date	February 1, 2015

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

*** Actions must be taken when changes are reported by the client, another agency, another person, the fraud hotline, or another entity within * DCFS. Refer to K-520-LaCAP – PR. **

K-521-LaCAP * - PO ** MASS CHANGES

The state or federal government initiates changes that can affect all or a large number of clients.

Mass changes will be made when there are changes in:

- Eligibility criteria based on Legislative or Regulatory Actions,
- The Thrifty Food Plan (allotment amounts),
- Cost-of-Living-Adjustments, and
- The utility standards.

II. PROCEDURES

* K-520-LACAP – PR ACTIONS ON CHANGES

The following actions must be taken when changes are reported by the client, another agency, another person, the fraud hotline, or another entity within DCFS:

- Document the reported change and the date of the report.
- Determine the effect of the reported change on the household's eligibility and benefits.
 - If the change was reported by a person other than the client, another agency (other than SSA) or another entity within DCFS, contact the client to confirm the accuracy of the reported change.
- Take action within 10 days to make the changes and notify the household.
 - If the reported change results in ineligibility, the case may be closed without requesting information from the client. Send appropriate notice.

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- If the reported change is an increase in shelter expenses and results in an increase in benefits, make the change and send concurrent notice.
- If the reported change is a decrease in shelter expenses and results in a decrease in benefits, make the change for the earliest possible month based on the client's statement. Send appropriate notice.

Complete form OFS 20CD if the change cannot be made effective the first month benefits should have been reduced or terminated.

If the reported change results in an increase in benefits, increase benefits effective the month after the change is reported. Authorize supplemental benefits, if necessary. (See K-540 for procedures to determine the first month benefits are affected.)

Staff should investigate and act upon changes learned outside the course of their employment if the change clearly makes the household ineligible.

Example: Learn of the death of the household member.

Do not investigate or act upon a change learned outside the course of employment if it does not clearly result in household ineligibility.

K-521-LaCAP - PR MASS CHANGES

The affected household must be sent a concurrent notice, LaCAP 4. If the client appeals within 13 days of this notice, benefits are reinstated only if the issue in the appeal is individual eligibility or benefits were improperly computed.

When such changes occur, the agency may automatically adjust eligibility or benefits for clients. In this situation, notices will be sent from State Office.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

[LaCAP 004 Form/Instructions Action Taken on Your LaCAP Case](#)

[OFS 020CD Form/Instructions Report of Claim Determination](#)

IV. REFERENCES

[LAC 67: 111 Subpart 3. Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program \(SNAP\) Chapter 21 Louisiana Combined Application Project Subchapter 2111, Section 2115.](#) **